

areas that have high power tariffs such as New Delhi and Mumbai. There are a total of 20 states and six union territories with defined net-metering guidelines. The map shown in Fig. 1 marks out the areas where net-metering guidelines are in place. So India does look progressive in achieving its 100GW target for solar!

If we look at the northern states of India and compare their tariffs in the commercial and residential sectors, we can clearly see that levelised cost of electricity (LCOE) from solar panels is much less than the tariffs that are being paid by top-slab customers. It is also evident that it makes sense for commercial customers, and residential is catching up, too.

### Net-metering specifications

As a general trend, the allotted transformer capacity for grid-connected solar power plants is be-

### SOLAR INSTALLATION CAPACITY

| Indian state  | Allotted transformer capacity | Solar power plant size allowed |
|---------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Haryana       | 30%                           | 100%                           |
| New Delhi     | 20%                           | No limit                       |
| Uttar Pradesh | 15%                           | 100%                           |
| Maharashtra   | 40%                           | 100%                           |
| Punjab        | 30%                           | 80%                            |
| Gujarat       | 30% (as in the draft policy)  | 50%                            |
| Rajasthan     | 30%                           | 80%                            |

tween 15 per cent and 30 per cent. Maharashtra as an exception has 40 per cent allotted transformer capacity for solar. The payback period largely depends on the tariff of the particular state. The higher the grid tariff, the lower the payback period.

Also, the question is about how much of your consumption can be offset using solar and how much you are allowed to install. So if you have been thinking that you will install only solar and not consume

from the grid at all, that is dependent on your state's regulations. For example, in Haryana you can install a capacity equalling 100 per cent of your connected load. However, in New Delhi, you have the option of exceeding your connected load by paying extra charges. The table gives you the figures of how much solar you can install as a percentage of the connected load.

The allotted transformer capacity is filled on a first-come first-serve basis. So if you are looking to benefit from rooftop solar for reducing your bill, you might want to consider doing this soon. Once the allotted transformer capacity is saturated, you may not be able to connect your system to the grid for a while. You can take a look at Sunkalp Energy's website ([www.sunkalp.com](http://www.sunkalp.com)), which is an aggregator that would help you go solar and connect to the grid. **EFY**

  
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